otherwise been kept under a cloak of confidentiality. That not once was security relaxed only exposes the fact that it was only the fear of accountability that had given the guise of confidentiality to these organizations.

At every stage there was a keen interaction with the community at large, which participated in a magnanimous way. Such confidence and faith exhibited by the community in a serving person can only be gained through honesty of intention and the will for achievement on the part of that individual.

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In 1985 the reputation of the Delhi Police was at an all-time low and the law and order situation was being condemned by one and all. The press was lambasting them left and right. Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi called up the commissioner of police, Ved Marwah, and told him to do something about it. The CP replied that there was nothing much he could do about it as long as he did not have the right officers with him. Rajiv Gandhi told him to ask for any officer and that person would be given to him. The CP asked for Kiran Bedi and found himself stonewalled. The antipathy towards her on the part of the PM's Office still continued and Rajiv Gandhi was quite aware of it.

The situation continued to deteriorate and, after a month and a half, the CP was called up again. This time, however, his request was granted and Kiran Bedi was transferred to headquarters as deputy commissioner of police (DCP). She found herself inundated with files, files and files. The table tops were overflowing with files and drawers were jammed shut because of them. Kiran adopted the policy of taking spot decisions and would dispose of the file there and then. The staff under her was a demoralized lot, burdened with problems ranging from lack of accommodation to lack of promotions. She wanted a large map to be displayed that showed the various police apartments lying vacant in the various districts. The allotment of these apartments had been used as a lever of influence to establish authority and to curry favour. The staff members were called to be interviewed before their posting so that, wherever possible, the officers could be accommodated nearer home, and they did not have to continue travelling 40 to 50 km daily. Lack of convenient accommodation had been one of the chief grouses of the police personnel and also one of the reasons given for their inefficiency. History was created at police HQ when 1600 promotions were made in a single day. These cases had been pending for the past six to seven years and no one had shown any concern for them. Kiran attributes the results to the dynamism of Ved Marwah and his eagerness for getting results.

The drivers in the HQ pool were inspired by Kiran's problem-solving approach and took their case to her. They maintained that from the day they joined service to the day they retired, they remained constables without any promotion whatsoever. Bedi took up their case and recommended a three-tier promotion system for them to the Home Ministry. She suggested that they should be promoted from constable to head constable and finally to subinspector. The Home Ministry merely sat on the file. Bedi then told the drivers to file a writ of mandamus in the Delhi High Court and to make Police Headquarters (PHQ) a party. The court took up the case and summoned her. She, of course, said that PHQ agreed completely with the drivers' cause and that the commissioner of police had recommended a three-tier grade. The court then directed the Home Ministry to look into the matter of the drivers' promotion and that is how today many police drivers retire as subinspectors. Kiran's driver who was a constable in the late 1970s later became a subinspector.

Standing instructions were issued by Kiran to her office staff that if any file was not cleared within three days, the person concerned would be called to personally explain the delay. They realized she meant business when they saw her clearing the tremendous backlog that she had inherited, and put